GROUNDING

3 Grounding Techniques That Actually Work

When anxiety spikes, your nervous system needs a signal that the threat is over. Here are 3 ways to send it.

1. The 5-4-3-2-1 method.

Name 5 things you can see. 4 you can touch. 3 you can hear. 2 you can smell. 1 you can taste. This pulls your attention out of the anxious mind and back into the present-moment body. It works.

2. Box breathing.

Inhale 4 counts. Hold 4. Exhale 4. Hold 4. Repeat 4 times. This directly activates your parasympathetic nervous system — your body's built-in calm response. Four minutes. Meaningful shift.

3. Cold water on your face.

Splash cold water on your face or hold ice in your hands. This activates the dive reflex, slowing your heart rate and interrupting panic almost immediately. Simple. Fast. Clinically supported.

Your nervous system can learn to feel safe.

Save this for your next anxious moment.